

Bedtime Tales

The Firefly Dance



KIDS BOOK VIDEOS

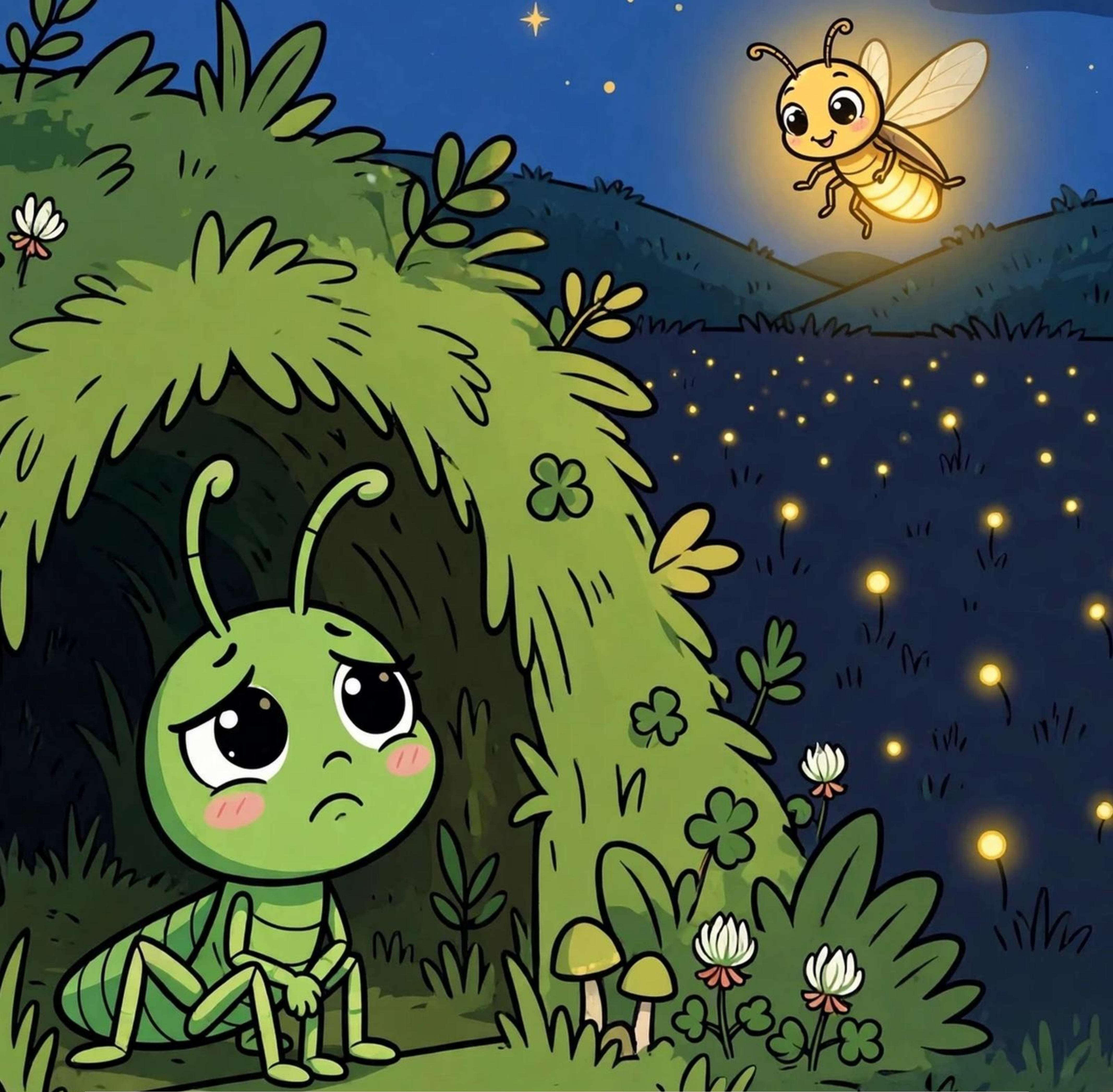


Cora the cricket could not fall asleep. She tossed in her grass bed, turning this way and that, feeling restless and fidgety. She hopped to her doorway. Firefly Meadow in Willowmere Wood glowed with tiny lights — dozens of fireflies floating in the dark, blinking on and off, on and off. It looked like a dance.



Curious, Cora sat very still and watched. The fireflies moved in patterns — first a circle (blink, blink, blink), then a wavy line (blink, blink, blink).

"It is a light dance!" Cora whispered, delighted.



One firefly drifted close to her. "Would you like to join?" it blinked. Fireflies talk in blinks, you know.

"But I cannot glow," said Cora sadly.



"You can tap," blinked the firefly. "Tap your feet to our rhythm. Every dancer is welcome."

Happiness bubbled up in Cora. She tapped her tiny feet — tap-tap-tap — while the fireflies blinked around her. Blink and twirl, twirl and blink.



"Blink and twirl, twirl and blink," hummed the night.

Cora tapped faster, and the fireflies spun in a spiral, their lights making golden swirls in the dark. Cora laughed — dancing was the most fun ever.



"Blink and twirl, twirl and blink," hummed the night again. But soon Cora's feet felt tired, and her tapping grew slower. Tap... tap... tap. The fireflies slowed too, and their dance became gentle and dreamy.



"Blink and twirl, twirl and blink," hummed the night one last time.

Cora yawned — dancing had tired her out in the best way. She curled up in her grass bed while the fireflies kept dancing softly outside, their blinks slow now, like sleepy eyes closing.



Blink... blink... blink. Cora's own eyes blinked the same way. Open... closed... open... closed. She felt drowsy and peaceful. The firefly dance became her lullaby. She dreamed she was dancing on beams of moonlight, twirling with a thousand tiny stars — she had danced beautifully tonight.



Dream of golden light, and rest your tired feet.



Sleep now, little Cora.

Sleep now, little Cora.

The End

